

Cycle financing and a period lower bound for the Juggler map

Philippe Cochin
philippe@cochin.fr

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Abstract

The Juggler map is the nonlinear integer map

$$J(n) = \begin{cases} \lfloor \sqrt{n} \rfloor, & n \text{ even,} \\ \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor, & n \text{ odd.} \end{cases}$$

It is conjectured that every positive integer eventually reaches 1.

A realized parity word obeys a power envelope, so a cycle word is formally expanding. Floor remainders must finance the surplus $3^o - 2^L$. At a cycle minimum this yields the financing inequality

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o.$$

Combined with the independently verified descent that every start through 10^6 reaches 1, there is no nontrivial cycle of length at most 25780. Equivalently, any nontrivial cycle has period at least 25781. A separate inverse-cell analysis shows that every nontrivial cycle has at least four even letters, and hence period at least eleven.

The core mathematical lemmas are mechanized in Lean 4; selected finite classifications and the descent floor are independently certified computations.

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1. Introduction

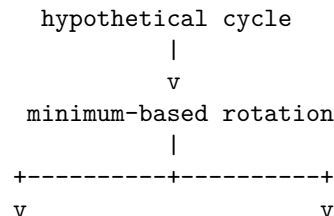
The Juggler sequence was introduced by Pickover [1,2]. The one-step map is OEIS A094683 [3]; the stopping-time table is A007320 [4]. The orbit of 3 is 3, 5, 11, 36, 6, 2, 1. The orbit of 37 already peaks at 24906114455136. Universal arrival at 1 remains the open conjecture of the subject.

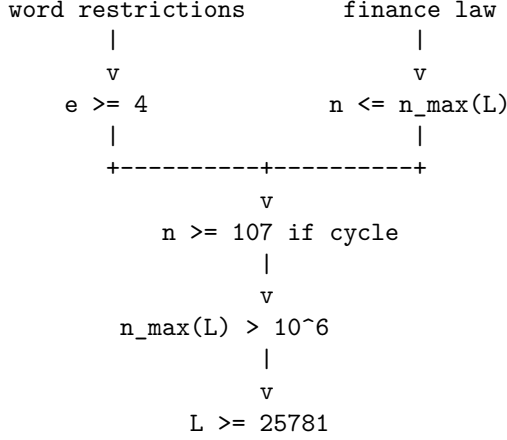
The map combines a contracting even branch with an expanding odd branch,

$$E(n) = \lfloor n^{1/2} \rfloor, \quad O(n) = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor.$$

A word of length k with o odd letters has ideal exponent $3^o/2^k$. Floors are applied after every letter, and a word is available only when the orbit realizes those parities.

The architecture is





Section 3 excludes every cycle word with fewer than four even letters, so the period is at least eleven. Section 4 converts floor defects into a bound on the cycle minimum. With the verified descent floor through 10^6 , that bound excludes every period at most 25780.

Write $N_0 = 10^6$ for the *verified descent floor*: the computational verification reported by Weisstein [5], recomputed here by exact first-passage. The contribution is the structural implication: exact floor defects finance the formal expansion of a cycle word, and therefore force the minimum of a hypothetical cycle below the verified descent region unless the period is at least 25781.

Throughout, $\mathbb{N} = \{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$. Write J^k for the k -fold iterate. A nonempty realized word w with $J^{|w|}(n) = n$ is a *cycle word*. The unique fixed point is 1; a cycle is *nontrivial* when it contains some $n \geq 2$. A cycle word at n is *minimum-based* when n is a cycle minimum: $J^j(n) \geq n$ for every $0 \leq j < |w|$. Every cycle word has a minimum-based rotation.

All exceptional sets below are *finance-survivor* sets: lengths that a stated form of the finance inequality does not exclude at the verified descent floor. They are not candidate cycle sets.

1.0 Main results

Contribution 1 — cycle-financing inequality. For a minimum-based cycle of length L with o odd steps,

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o$$

(Theorem 4.4). Floor defects become a quantitative bound on the cycle minimum.

Contribution 2 — structural word obstruction. Every nontrivial cycle word has at least four even letters, and hence period at least eleven (Theorem 3.22 and Corollary 3.23). The argument classifies the minimum-based word geometry; it is not a raw census of words of length at most ten. This bound does not use the verified descent floor.

Contribution 3 — explicit global consequence. Combined with the independently verified descent floor $N_0 = 10^6$, there is no nontrivial Juggler cycle of length at most 25780. Equivalently, any nontrivial cycle has period at least 25781 (Theorem 4.6(A)).

The supporting material of Section 4 records the finance-survivor lengths through 10^5 : an explicit set $\mathcal{E}$ of 141 lengths (Theorem 4.6(B)), of which run-type packing leaves 99 (Theorem 4.8), organised as three affine families (Proposition 4.9). Membership means only that the corresponding form of the inequality does not exclude L .

Theorems 4.6(A) and 4.6(B) are the finance inequality of Theorem 4.4, in the conservative $6/5$ form of Corollary 4.5, at the verified descent floor reported by Weisstein [5].

1.1 Related work

Pickover’s later exposition is Chapter 45 of [2]. Weisstein [5] records the map, the stopping-time sequences A094670, A094679, A095908, and a verification of arrival at 1 through 10^6 . That verified descent floor is the computational input to Theorem 4.6; the first-passage run of Appendix B recomputes it. OEIS A094716 [6] records extreme heights, including the start 48443 whose peak has 972 463 digits. Those height records do not bound the period.

We found no published result establishing an explicit lower bound on the period of a nontrivial cycle for this exact floor-power Juggler map. Prasad–Prasad [7] estimate excursion and stopping constants for juggler-like maps by a random-walk large-deviation model; those estimates do not apply to exact cycles. Small-cycle censuses are a standard first layer for Collatz-like maps, surveyed by Lagarias [8,9]. Those results do not transfer: the branches of J are floor powers rather than affine maps (Crandall [10], Matthews–Watts [11]). In particular there is no identity of the form $n(2^K - 3^p) = C$.

The layers of the argument are as follows.

1. *Classical idea*: cycle financing (Simons–de Weger [12]).
2. *Classical idea*: logarithmic and continued-fraction approximation of $\log 2 / \log 3$.
3. *Classical idea*: cycle-word restrictions and leftover packaging (Eliahou [13]; Lagarias [8,9]).
4. *New object*: the exact one-step floor-power cells of J .
5. *New theorem*: the Juggler-specific cycle-minimum finance inequality of Theorem 4.4.
6. *New consequence*: $L \geq 25781$ at the verified descent floor 10^6 .
7. *New computational organization*: the run-packing description of the finance-survivor lengths (Theorems 4.7–4.8, Proposition 4.9).

Financing as an idea, logarithmic step inequalities, and the continued-fraction phenomenon are not claimed as new. The argument below is elementary and independent of the Diophantine tools of [12]: floor-power defects are relatively $O(1/x)$ in logarithms, so a uniform logarithmic floor-error bound, valid above the verified floor, excludes every length that is not a finance-survivor for Theorem 4.4. The Juggler-specific inequality and the explicit period bound it produces appear to be new. A systematic literature search remains an external-review gate.

Novelty statement. For this nonlinear floor-power map, exact floor defects convert into a cycle-financing inequality that forces the minimum of a hypothetical cycle below the independently verified descent region unless the period is at least 25781.

1.2 Verification

The arguments of Sections 2, 3, and 4 may be read without machine assistance. The core mathematical lemmas are mechanized in Lean 4; selected finite classifications and numerical tables are independently certified computations. Appendix A records the Lean names. The finite tables used by Lemmas 3.5, 3.7, 3.11 and Theorems 3.12–3.20 are `native_decide` evaluations in the modules named there.

Proposition 1.3 (certified computational input). A machine-verifiable certificate establishes that every integer $2 \leq n \leq 10^6$ reaches 1. Precisely: an exact-integer first-passage run records, for each such n , a finite realized word with image strictly below the start; strong induction on that image reaches 1. The longest first passage in the window has 253 steps (seed 78901). Weisstein [5] records the same computational verification; the run here is an independent recomputation. The certificate files, SHA-256 hashes, and regeneration commands are Appendix B.

Theorem 4.6 applies Corollary 4.5 to this input, together with an exact gap table of lengths up to 10^5 . Theorems 4.7–4.8 reuse that table under the run-type packing. Proposition 4.9 is integer arithmetic, formalized in Lean; the identification of the 99 lattice points with $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$ is the table of Theorem 4.8. Theorem 4.7 is a human proof. This is not a claim that the paper as a whole is formally verified.

Repository: https://github.com/sneakyweasel/balanced_ternary
Commit: 7802f78bec58c68cec92a2efb3db4a502f916277
Lean: leanprover/lean4:v4.33.0

Mathlib: v4.33.0 (lake-manifest rev db584cd6d46c92f209a44c0f1c829460d327499d)
 Build: lake build Problems.JugglerPaper (from formal/)
 Computation: python -m research.juggler_sequence.cycle_finance
 (parity table); run-type table in budget_opt.json
 SHA-256: Appendix B

The commit is the repository state that produced the finance tables. A later editorial commit of this text does not change those hashes.

2. Envelope

Let $\mathcal{B} = \{E, O\}$. A finite word $w \in \mathcal{B}^*$ is *realized* at $n \in \mathbb{N}$ when the successive parities of the orbit of n are exactly the letters of w . Write $J^{|w|}(n)$ for the endpoint after those letters, and $\#O(w)$ for the number of odd letters. When w is realized, this endpoint is the $|w|$ -fold iterate.

Theorem 2.1 (fixed-word monotonicity). If $n \leq m$ and both realize w , then $J^{|w|}(n) \leq J^{|w|}(m)$.

Proof. Induct on w . The empty word is immediate. The images after a common realized prefix remain ordered, and both current states realize the same next letter. The even branch is the monotone integer square root; the odd branch is $x \mapsto x^3$ followed by the integer square root. $\square$

The realizing set of a fixed word need not be an interval: OE is realized at 7 and at 11 but not at 9.

Theorem 2.2 (finite-word power envelope). If w is realized at n and $m = J^{|w|}(n)$, then

$$m^{2^{|w|}} \leq n^{3^{\#O(w)}}.$$

Proof. The empty word is the equality $n \leq n$. Suppose a realized prefix of length ℓ with odd count o ends at x and satisfies $x^{2^\ell} \leq n^{3^o}$, and the next letter is realized.

If the next letter is even, then $J(x)^2 \leq x$. Raising the inductive bound to the second power gives

$$J(x)^{2^{\ell+1}} = (J(x)^2)^{2^\ell} \leq x^{2^\ell} \leq n^{3^o}.$$

The odd count is unchanged.

If the next letter is odd, then $J(x)^2 \leq x^3$, so

$$J(x)^{2^{\ell+1}} = (J(x)^2)^{2^\ell} \leq x^{3 \cdot 2^\ell} = (x^{2^\ell})^3 \leq (n^{3^o})^3 = n^{3^{o+1}}.$$

This is the claimed bound after one more odd letter. $\square$

Corollary 2.3 (exponent-gap contraction). If $n \geq 2$, w is realized at n , and $3^{\#O(w)} < 2^{|w|}$, then $J^{|w|}(n) < n$.

Proof. Let $m = J^{|w|}(n)$ and $k = |w|$. Theorem 2.2 gives $m^{2^k} \leq n^{3^{\#O(w)}}$. The exponent gap and $n \geq 2$ give $n^{3^{\#O(w)}} < n^{2^k}$, so $m^{2^k} < n^{2^k}$. Since $m \geq 1$, one has $m < n$. $\square$

The corollary includes familiar contracting blocks such as $OOOEE$. It does not prove that every start realizes some contracting word.

2.4 Exact floor defect

Theorem 2.2 is the inequality form of an exact identity

$$n^{3^{\#O(w)}} = J^{|w|}(n)^{2^{|w|}} + \Delta_w(n), \quad \Delta_w(n) \geq 0.$$

The identity, its vanishing law, and the two-term composition are Theorems 2.4–2.6 and Corollary 2.7 in Appendix C. A mixed realized word has $\Delta_w(n) > 0$. We record this stronger exact identity for future work;

the present theorems require only its nonnegativity. Theorem 4.4 is a logarithmic envelope argument and does not take Δ_w as an input.

A quantitative lower bound stronger than positivity — a run-level, valley-level, or minimum-return tax on Δ_w — would improve the finance bound. No such uniform local tax exists: the relative slack of a single letter tends to 0 with the state. A dual refinement is a tighter upper bound on the state sum $\sum 1/(x_i \log x_i)$ itself, using realizable cycle geometry rather than a uniform price; that is named in Section 5 and is not proved here.

3. Inverse cells and the census

The aim of this section is a structural even-count obstruction, not a length-by-length census. After the one-step cells and the small-period reductions, the argument has three layers.

Structural lemma. Any minimum-based cycle with at most three even letters has one of finitely many canonical geometries $O^aEO^bEO^cE$ (Lemma 3.21b).

Elimination lemma. Each geometry falls into one of three mechanisms (Lemma 3.21a): a next-square obstruction, long odd-run growth against a last-even cell, or a finite exceptional window. The family theorems 3.12–3.21 record that exhaustion; their proofs are Appendix D.

Corollary. Every nontrivial cycle has at least four even letters, and hence period at least eleven (Theorem 3.22, Corollary 3.23).

The exact one-step fibers are

$$J(n) = q \iff q^2 \leq n < (q+1)^2 \quad (n \text{ even})$$

and

$$J(n) = m \iff m^2 \leq n^3 < (m+1)^2 \quad (n \text{ odd}).$$

Lemma 3.1 (odd cells are unique). An odd fiber contains at most one integer. An even fiber is a parity-restricted square interval and may contain many predecessors.

Proof. Suppose $a < b$ lie in the same odd cell indexed by m . Then $(a+1)^3 \leq b^3 < (m+1)^2$ and $m^2 \leq a^3$. Subtracting the latter lower bound from the former upper bound gives

$$3a^2 + 3a + 1 = (a+1)^3 - a^3 < (m+1)^2 - m^2 = 2m + 1,$$

hence $3a^2 + 3a < 2m$ and $3a^2 < 2m$. If $a = 0$, then $m = 0$ and the displayed strict inequality is already impossible. If $a > 0$, squaring and using $m^2 \leq a^3$ gives $9a^4 < 4m^2 \leq 4a^3$, contradicting $4a^3 < 9a^4$. $\square$

Theorem 3.2 (cycle restrictions). Let w be a cycle word at $n \geq 2$.

- (i) The word is formally expanding:

$$2^{|w|} < 3^{\#O(w)}.$$

A contracting word cannot close a nontrivial cycle.

- (ii) The cycle minimum is odd and the cycle maximum is even. A minimum-based orientation cannot end in an odd letter.

- (iii) A realized word v is *superquadratic* if

$$3^{\#O(v)} \geq 2^{|v|+1}.$$

Any realized path from a start $n \geq 2$ to a state at least n^2 is superquadratic. On a cycle minimum the path to any later even state is superquadratic. The prefix OOE is expanding ($9 > 8$) but not superquadratic ($9 < 16$), so it cannot carry the minimum to square scale.

Proof. For (i), Theorem 2.2 applied to a cycle endpoint gives $n^{2^{|w|}} \leq n^{3^{\#O(w)}}$. Since $n \geq 2$, comparison of exponents gives $2^{|w|} \leq 3^{\#O(w)}$; equality is impossible because the two sides have different prime divisors and $|w| \geq 1$. Alternatively: a mixed cycle word has $\Delta_w(n) > 0$ by Theorem 2.5 in Appendix C, so the envelope is strict; a monochrome tower cannot return for $n \geq 2$.

Every state on such a cycle is at least 2: once an orbit reaches 1, it remains there and cannot return to a start $n \geq 2$. An even state $x \geq 2$ satisfies $J(x) < x$, so a cycle minimum cannot be even. An odd state $x \geq 3$ satisfies $J(x) > x$, so a cycle maximum cannot be odd. This proves the first assertion of (ii). For the final-letter assertion, let x be the predecessor of a minimum-oriented return n . If the last letter were odd, the odd return cell would give $n^2 \leq x^3 < (n+1)^2$. Minimality gives $x \geq n$, hence $n^3 < (n+1)^2$, impossible for $n \geq 3$; and the minimum is odd, so $n \geq 3$.

For (iii), let a realized word v send n to $y \geq n^2$. Theorem 2.2 gives

$$n^{2^{|v|+1}} = (n^2)^{2^{|v|}} \leq y^{2^{|v|}} \leq n^{3^{\#O(v)}}.$$

Since $n \geq 2$, comparison of exponents proves the superquadratic inequality. On a cycle minimum, if a later state y is even, its successor is at least n . Thus $n \leq J(y) = \lfloor \sqrt{y} \rfloor$, so $n^2 \leq y$, and the preceding argument applies to that prefix. $\square$

Lemma 3.3 (coarse lower envelope). For $n \geq 1$, write $q = \lfloor \sqrt{n} \rfloor$. Then $q^2 \leq n < (q+1)^2$. For $q \geq 1$ one has $(q+1)^2 \leq 4q^2$, and the second inequality is strict for $q \geq 2$, while for $q = 1$ one has $n < 4$. In all cases

$$n < 4 \lfloor \sqrt{n} \rfloor^2.$$

Thus an even step satisfies $n \leq 4J(n)^2$ and an odd step satisfies $n^3 \leq 4J(n)^2$. Composing along a realized word v of length k with odd count o gives

$$n^{3^o} \leq C_v J^k(n)^{2^k}.$$

The constant starts at 1 and updates by $C \mapsto C \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an even letter and $C \mapsto C^3 \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an odd letter, at step j . In particular $C_{OOO} = 2^{38}$ and $C_{OOOO} = 2^{130}$.

Proof. The comparison $n < 4q^2$ is the paragraph above. The composition law is the same recurrence as the proof of Theorem 2.2, with a factor 4^{2^j} inserted at each letter. The values C_{OOO} and C_{OOOO} are the result of that recurrence on those two words. $\square$

Lemma 3.4 (next-square thresholds). (i) If $q \geq 5$ realizes OO , then $J^2(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. (ii) If $q \geq 3$ realizes OOO , then $J^3(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. (iii) If a realized word v satisfies $J^{|v|}(q) \geq (q+1)^2$ and the next realized letter is odd, then $J^{|v|+1}(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. (iv) If vE is a cycle word at n , then $J^{|v|}(n) < (n+1)^2$. (v) If $a \geq 3$, then $O^a E$ is not a cycle word at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. For (i), write $m = \lfloor q^{3/2} \rfloor$. The bound $J^2(q) \geq (q+1)^2$ follows from $m^3 \geq (q+1)^4$, because then $\lfloor m^{3/2} \rfloor \geq (q+1)^2$. If $q = 5$, then $11^2 = 121 \leq 125 = 5^3 < 144 = 12^2$, so $m = 11$, and $11^3 = 1331 \geq 6^4 = 1296$. Since q realizes OO , it is odd, so the only remaining case is $q \geq 7$. Then $m \geq q^{3/2} - 1$, so it is enough that $(q^{3/2} - 1)^3 \geq (q+1)^4$. Expanding the left side and dropping the positive remainder $3q^{3/2} - 1$ reduces this to $q^{9/2} - 3q^3 \geq (q+1)^4$, or equivalently $\sqrt{q} - 3/q \geq (1 + 1/q)^4$. The left side increases for $q > 0$ and the right side decreases, so the case $q = 7$ suffices:

$$\sqrt{7} - \frac{3}{7} > \frac{5}{2} - \frac{3}{7} = \frac{29}{14} > \frac{4096}{2401} = \left(\frac{8}{7}\right)^4,$$

where $\sqrt{7} > 5/2$ follows from $25/4 < 7$.

For (ii), the orbit $3 \rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 11 \rightarrow 36$ gives $J^3(3) = 36 \geq 16$. If $q \geq 5$ realizes OOO , then it realizes OO , so (i) gives $J^2(q) \geq (q+1)^2$. The third letter is odd, hence $J^3(q) = J(J^2(q)) \geq J^2(q)$.

For (iii), the image after v is odd and at least $(q+1)^2 \geq 4$, so the odd branch does not decrease it.

For (iv), the last letter is even, so the preimage $z = J^{|v|}(n)$ is even and satisfies $n^2 \leq z < (n+1)^2$.

For (v), suppose $O^a E$ is a cycle word at $n \geq 2$. The start is odd, hence at least 3, and realizes O^a . Parts (ii) and (iii) give $J^a(n) \geq (n+1)^2$, contradicting (iv). $\square$

Lemma 3.5 (two length-six exclusions). Neither $OOOEOE$ nor $OOOOEE$ is a cycle word at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. First, if $n \geq 256$, then

$$n^{81} > 2^{130}(n+1)^{64}.$$

Indeed $257^{64} < 2 \cdot 256^{64}$ because $(1+1/256)^{64} < e^{64/256} = e^{1/4} < 2$, and $256(n+1) \leq 257n$, so $(n+1)^{64} < 2n^{64}$. Then $2^{130}(n+1)^{64} < 2^{131}n^{64}$. Since $n \geq 256 = 2^8$, one has $n^{17} \geq 2^{136}$, and therefore $2^{131}n^{64} < 2^{136}n^{64} \leq n^{81}$.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, neither word returns to its start. This is a table of 254 evaluations of each word: at every start, either some letter fails to match the current parity, or the six-step image differs from the start. The same finite check is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_oooooe` and `no_cycle_word_ooooee` (Appendix A).

Now suppose $OOOOEE$ is a cycle word at $n \geq 256$, and write $z = J^4(n)$ for the image after the prefix $OOOO$. Lemma 3.4(iv) gives $J(z) < (n+1)^2$, and the preceding even letter gives $z < (J(z)+1)^2$, hence $z < (n+1)^4$. Lemma 3.3 on $OOOO$ gives $n^{81} \leq 2^{130}z^{16}$, so $n^{81} < 2^{130}(n+1)^{64}$, contradicting the tail inequality.

Finally suppose $OOOEOE$ is a cycle word at $n \geq 256$. Write $z_3 = J^3(n)$ and $y = J(z_3) = \lfloor \sqrt{z_3} \rfloor$, so $z_3 < (y+1)^2$. Lemma 3.3 on OOO gives $n^{27} \leq 2^{38}z_3^8 < 2^{38}(y+1)^{16}$. Cubing yields $n^{81} < 2^{114}(y+1)^{48}$. The last letters OE give the odd-cell bound $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. Write $A = n+1 \geq 257$. We claim $(y+1)^3 < 2A^4$. If $y \leq A$, this is $(A+1)^3 < 2A^4$. If $y > A$, then $y \geq 258$, so $3y+1 < y^2$ and hence $(y+1)^3 = y^3 + 3y^2 + 3y + 1 < A^4 + 4y^2$, while $4y^2 < A^4$ because $4y^3 < 4A^4 \leq yA^4$. Raising $(y+1)^3 < 2A^4$ to the sixteenth power gives $(y+1)^{48} < 2^{16}(n+1)^{64}$. Combining with the cubed lower envelope produces again $n^{81} < 2^{130}(n+1)^{64}$. $\square$

Theorem 3.6 (small-cycle census). No word of length at most six is a cycle word at any $n \geq 2$. Equivalently, a nontrivial Juggler cycle, if one exists, has period at least seven.

Proof. Rotating a cycle word by one letter moves the base point one step along the orbit and yields another cycle word; every state of the cycle is at least 2, because an orbit that reaches 1 stays at 1 and cannot return to a start $n \geq 2$.

If every letter is odd, the start is odd, hence $n \geq 3$, and the odd branch strictly increases there: $J(x) > x$ for odd $x \geq 3$, since $x^3 \geq (x+1)^2$. The orbit ascends strictly and never returns. Otherwise some letter is even, and a rotation ending just after that letter produces an even-terminating cycle word vE of the same length based at a cycle state $m \geq 2$. It therefore suffices to exclude even-terminating cycle words of length at most six.

By Theorem 3.2(i) a cycle word is formally expanding. No even-terminating word of length one or two is expanding ($2 > 3^0$ and $4 > 3$).

Length three: the only expanding candidate is OOE . If $m \geq 5$ realizes OO , Lemma 3.4(i) gives $J^2(m) \geq (m+1)^2$, contradicting Lemma 3.4(iv). The only smaller odd start is $m = 3$, where $J^2(3) = 11$ is odd, so the final even letter is not realized.

Length four: the expanding filter requires three odd letters among the first three, leaving only O^3E , excluded by Lemma 3.4(v).

Length five: the filter requires four odd letters among the first four, leaving only O^4E , excluded by Lemma 3.4(v).

Length six: the filter requires at least four odd letters among the first five, leaving O^5E , $EOOOOE$, $OEEOOE$, $OOEOOE$, and $OOOOEE$. Lemma 3.4(v) excludes O^5E . The word $EOOOOE$ rotates one step onto $OOOOEE$, and $OEEOOE$ rotates two steps onto $OOOEOE$; both are excluded by Lemma 3.5.

It remains to exclude $OOEOOE$. Let this word be a cycle word at some start, and rotate to a cycle minimum $m \geq 2$. The three alignments of the two even letters are $OOEOOE$, $OEOOEO$, and $EOOEOO$. The last

starts even, so it cannot be a minimum, by Theorem 3.2(ii). The middle starts OE : the first image is even and strictly below m^2 , whereas every even state after a cycle minimum is at least m^2 , as proved in Theorem 3.2(iii). Thus the minimum orientation is $OOEOOE$. In particular m is odd, so $m \geq 3$. The prefix OOE must be realized. If $m = 3$, then $3 \rightarrow 5 \rightarrow 11$ and 11 is odd, so OOE is not realized. Hence $m \geq 5$. Write $y = J^3(m)$ for the state after OOE . Then $y \geq m$ by minimality, so $y \geq 5$. The suffix OO is realized at y , and Lemma 3.4(i) gives $J^2(y) \geq (y+1)^2 \geq (m+1)^2$. The last letter is even, so Lemma 3.4(iv) gives $J^2(y) < (m+1)^2$. $\square$

Lemma 3.4(v) excludes every odd-run-then-even word O^aE with $a \geq 3$, of any length.

Lemma 3.7 (two length-seven exclusions). Neither $OOOOEOE$ nor $OOOOOEE$ is a cycle word at any $n \geq 2$.

Proof. First, if $n \geq 14$, then

$$n^{243} > 2^{422}(n+1)^{128}.$$

Indeed $14(n+1) \leq 15n$, so $(n+1)^{128} \leq (15/14)^{128}n^{128}$. The finite comparison $2^{422}15^{128} < 14^{243}$ then yields $2^{422}(n+1)^{128} < 14^{115}n^{128} \leq n^{243}$.

For $2 \leq n < 14$, neither word is realized: at every such start, some letter fails to match the current parity. The same finite check is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_ooooeoe` and `no_cycle_word_oooooee` (Appendix A).

Now suppose $OOOOOEE$ is a cycle word at $n \geq 14$, and write $z = J^5(n)$ for the image after the prefix $OOOOO$. Lemma 3.4(iv) on the last even letter, together with the preceding even letter, gives $z < (n+1)^4$. Lemma 3.3 on $OOOOO$ gives $n^{243} \leq 2^{422}z^{32}$, so $n^{243} < 2^{422}(n+1)^{128}$, contradicting the tail inequality.

Finally suppose $OOOOEOE$ is a cycle word at $n \geq 14$. Write $z_4 = J^4(n)$ and $y = J(z_4) = \lfloor \sqrt{z_4} \rfloor$, so $z_4 < (y+1)^2$. Lemma 3.3 on $OOOO$ gives $n^{81} \leq 2^{130}z_4^{16} < 2^{130}(y+1)^{32}$. Cubing yields $n^{243} < 2^{390}(y+1)^{96}$. The last letters OE give the odd-cell bound $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. Write $A = n+1 \geq 15$. The same comparison $(y+1)^3 < 2A^4$ as in Lemma 3.5 holds at this smaller scale. Raising to the thirty-second power gives $(y+1)^{96} < 2^{32}(n+1)^{128}$. Combining with the cubed lower envelope produces again $n^{243} < 2^{422}(n+1)^{128}$. $\square$

Theorem 3.8 (small-cycle census through length seven). No word of length at most seven is a cycle word at any $n \geq 2$. Equivalently, a nontrivial Juggler cycle, if one exists, has period at least eight.

Proof. The reduction of Theorem 3.6 applies at every length: an all-odd word cannot return, and every mixed cycle word rotates to an even-terminating cycle word based at a cycle state $m \geq 2$. Lengths at most six are Theorem 3.6. It remains to exclude even-terminating cycle words of length seven.

By Theorem 3.2(i) a cycle word is formally expanding. The even-terminating expanding length-seven words are exactly O^6E , EO^5E , OEO^4E , $OOEO^3E$, O^3EO^2E , O^4EOE , and O^5EE . Lemma 3.4(v) excludes O^6E . The word EO^5E rotates one step onto O^5EE , and OEO^4E starts OE , so it cannot be a cycle minimum (Theorem 3.2(iii)) and rotates two steps onto O^4EOE ; both leftovers are excluded by Lemma 3.7.

It remains to exclude $OOEO^3E$ and O^3EO^2E . Rotate either word to a cycle minimum $m \geq 2$. For $OOEO^3E$ the minimum orientation retains the internal even letter followed by the suffix OOO . Then $m \geq 3$, the prefix through that even letter is realized, and Lemma 3.4(ii) at threshold 3 contradicts the last even cell. For O^3EO^2E the same bootstrap applies with suffix OO and threshold 5, once $m = 3$ is removed: at $m = 3$ the state after OOO is even, so the next even letter is not realized. $\square$

The census of Theorems 3.6 and 3.8 is a statement about period. The same cells organise leftover words by even-count. Write

$$e_a = 2(3^a - 2^a)$$

for $a \geq 0$.

Lemma 3.9 (trailing even run). If a cycle word based at n ends with $r \geq 1$ even letters, the state immediately before that run is strictly less than $(n+1)^{2^r}$.

Proof. The case $r = 1$ is Lemma 3.4(iv). Suppose the claim holds for some $r \geq 1$, and let vE^{r+1} be a cycle word at n . Write $z = J^{|v|}(n)$. The inductive hypothesis applied to the suffix E^r after the first of those even letters gives $J(z) < (n+1)^{2^r}$. The state z is even, so $z < (J(z) + 1)^2 \leq ((n+1)^{2^r})^2 = (n+1)^{2^{r+1}}$. $\square$

Lemma 3.10 (odd-run lower envelope). If $n \geq 1$ realizes O^a , then

$$n^{3^a} \leq 2^{e_a} J^a(n)^{2^a}.$$

Proof. Lemma 3.3 supplies a multiplicative constant C_v along any realized word, with $C_\varepsilon = 1$, $C \mapsto C \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an even letter, and $C \mapsto C^3 \cdot 4^{2^j}$ on an odd letter, at step j . On the pure odd word O^a every letter is odd, so $C_{O^{a+1}} = C_{O^a}^3 \cdot 4^{2^a}$. Writing $C_{O^a} = 2^{e_a}$ with $e_0 = 0$ yields the recurrence $e_{a+1} = 3e_a + 2^{a+1}$, because $4^{2^a} = 2^{2^{a+1}}$. The closed form $e_a = 2(3^a - 2^a)$ satisfies the recurrence and the initial value. $\square$

Lemma 3.11 (seven-odd window). No integer n with $2 \leq n < 256$ realizes the word O^7 .

Proof. This is a table of 254 seven-step evaluations: at every such start, some letter fails to match the current parity. The same finite check is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_follows_seven_odds_of_1t256` (Appendix A). $\square$

Theorem 3.12 (two-even leftover families). Let $k \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. Neither $O^{k-2}EE$ nor $O^{k-3}EOE$ is a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

A cycle word w at n is *minimum-based* when n is a cycle minimum: $J^j(n) \geq n$ for every $0 \leq j < |w|$. The remainder after a proper prefix of a cycle word need not itself be a cycle word at the prefix endpoint. The next statement therefore transports the tail inequality of Theorem 3.12, not the cycle-word exclusion at a later start.

Theorem 3.13 (first-even transport). Let $n \geq 2$. No minimum-based cycle word at n has the form O^aEO^bEE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form O^aEO^bEOE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. Appendix D.

The hypothesis that the start is a cycle minimum is essential. If $y < n$, the leftover cell is measured against a larger start and need not contradict the tail at y . In particular, Theorem 3.13 does not assert that those words fail to be cycle words at a non-minimum start. That upgrade is Theorem 3.21.

Theorem 3.14 (three trailing evens). Let $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.15 (mixed bunched family EOEE). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEOEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.16 (mixed bunched family EOOEE). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEOOEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.17 (mixed bunched family EOOOEE). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The word $O^aEOOOEE$ is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.18 (mixed bunched family EEOE). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEEOE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.19 (mixed bunched family EOEOE). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEOEOE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.20 (mixed bunched family $EOOEOE$). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The word $O^a EOOEOE$ is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorem 3.21 (gapped leftovers as cycle words). Let $n \geq 2$. No cycle word at n has the form $O^a EO^b EE$ with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form $O^a EO^b EOE$ with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. Appendix D.

Theorems 3.12–3.21 assemble into an even-count exclusion: no cycle word has fewer than four even letters, so a nontrivial cycle has period at least eleven (Theorem 3.22). Section 4 excludes later periods by financing.

A cycle minimum starts with two odd letters, ends with an even letter, and is formally expanding (Theorem 3.2). Every integer $2 \leq n < 12$ reaches 1, so a cycle minimum is at least 12. Write e for the number of even letters.

Lemma 3.21b (canonical run form). After rotation to a minimum-based orientation, the word begins with OO and ends with E ; hence every word with $1 \leq e \leq 3$ even letters has the canonical run decomposition $O^a EO^b EO^c E$ (unused runs empty). The case $e = 0$ is all-odd and is already forbidden by the last-letter restriction. No other cyclic rotation needs a separate case.

Proof. Theorem 3.2: the minimum is odd, so the word cannot begin with E or OE , and it cannot end with an odd letter. Thus a minimum-based word starts OO and ends E , so $e \geq 1$. The remaining letters are odd runs separated by the e even letters, so the word is $O^{a_1} E \cdots O^{a_e} E$ with $a_1 \geq 2$. For $e \leq 3$ this is $O^a EO^b EO^c E$ with unused runs empty. Every cycle word has a minimum-based rotation of the same even-count, and that orientation is already in this form. $\square$

Lemma 3.21a (classification). Every minimum-based cycle word with at most three even letters belongs to one of the families excluded by Lemma 3.4(v) and Theorems 3.12–3.21.

Proof. Lemma 3.21b puts the word in the form $O^a EO^b EO^c E$ with $a \geq 2$ and unused runs empty. If $e = 0$, the word is all-odd. If $e = 1$, it is $O^a E$. If $e = 2$, a last run $c \geq 2$ is the internal-even bootstrap of Lemma 3.4, and the remaining shapes are the two-even families of Theorem 3.12. If $e = 3$, again $c \geq 2$ is the bootstrap, while $c \in \{0, 1\}$ is either a gapped leftover (Theorem 3.21) or one of the seven bunched families (Theorems 3.14–3.20). $\square$

	remaining minimum-based	
e	forms	elimination
0	all-odd	cannot return (Theorem 3.6)
1	$O^a E$	next-square; Lemma 3.4(v)
2	$O^a EE$, $O^a EOE$, last run ≥ 2	Theorem 3.12; Lemma 3.4
3	bunched families and gapped leftovers	Theorems 3.14–3.21
≥ 4	not excluded by even-count	finance (Section 4)

Theorem 3.22 (even-count). No word with fewer than four even letters is a cycle word at any $n \geq 2$. Equivalently, a nontrivial cycle word has at least four even letters.

Proof. Every cycle word has a minimum-based rotation, with the same even-count. Lemma 3.21b puts that orientation in canonical run form; Lemma 3.21a names the families. In detail:

If $e = 0$, the word is all-odd and cannot return, as in Theorem 3.6.

If $e = 1$, the word is $O^a E$ with $a \geq 2$. The case $a = 2$ is OOE , excluded in Theorem 3.6. The cases $a \geq 3$ are Lemma 3.4(v).

If $e = 2$, the word is O^aEO^cE with $a \geq 2$. A last odd-run $c \geq 2$ is an internal even letter followed by OO or OOO . Lemma 3.4 at the cycle minimum ($n \geq 12$) contradicts the last-even cell. The remaining shapes are O^aEE and O^aEOE . Expansion forces $a \geq 4$ and $a \geq 3$ respectively, so both are Theorem 3.12.

If $e = 3$, the word is $O^aEO^bEO^cE$ with $a \geq 2$. Again $c \geq 2$ is the internal-even bootstrap. The remaining last runs are $c = 0$ and $c = 1$. For $c = 0$ and $b \geq 4$ the word is a gapped leftover O^aEO^bEE , excluded by Theorem 3.21. For $c = 0$ and $b \leq 3$ the word is one of O^aEEE , O^aEOEE , O^aEOOEE , $O^aEOOOEE$, excluded by Theorems 3.14–3.17 once expansion supplies the stated lower bounds on a . For $c = 1$ and $b \geq 3$ the word is a gapped leftover O^aEO^bEOE , excluded by Theorem 3.21. For $c = 1$ and $b \leq 2$ the word is one of O^aEEOE , O^aEOEOE , $O^aEOOEOE$, excluded by Theorems 3.18–3.20.

Thus $e \leq 3$ is impossible. $\square$

Corollary 3.23. A nontrivial cycle, if one exists, has period at least eleven.

Proof. Theorem 3.22 gives four even letters, hence $o \leq L - 4$. Formal expansion is $2^L < 3^o \leq 3^{L-4}$. The comparison $2^L < 3^{L-4}$ first holds at $L = 11$. $\square$

In particular there is no cycle of length eight, nine, or ten.

4. Cycle finance

A cycle word is formally expanding (Theorem 3.2), yet the orbit returns exactly. The multiplicative surplus $3^o - 2^L$ must be financed by the floor remainders, which are relatively $O(1/x)$ in logarithms. The resulting bound on the cycle minimum excludes every period that is not admissible for the inequality, once a uniform logarithmic floor-error bound is available above a verified descent floor.

Throughout this section write $L = |w|$ and $o = \#O(w)$ for a cycle word w based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 2$. Natural logarithms are written $\log$. The unique one-step fibres of Section 3 give, for every state $x \geq 1$ with image $y = J(x)$,

$$y^2 \leq x^e < (y+1)^2, \quad e = \begin{cases} 1, & x \text{ even}, \\ 3, & x \text{ odd}. \end{cases}$$

Lemma 4.1 (dyadic-cell logarithm). If $z, y \geq 1$ and $z < (y+1)^2$, then $\log z \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$.

Proof. The hypothesis gives $\log z \leq 2 \log(y+1)$. The inequality $\log(1+u) \leq u$ for $u > 0$ yields $\log(y+1) = \log y + \log(1+1/y) \leq \log y + 1/y$. $\square$

Lemma 4.2 (one-step bounds). Let $x \geq 2$ and $y = J(x)$. If x is even, then $\log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$. If x is odd, then $3 \log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$.

Proof. The even cell is $y^2 \leq x < (y+1)^2$. The cell logarithm lemma on $z = x$ is the first claim. The odd cell is $y^2 \leq x^3 < (y+1)^2$. The same lemma on $z = x^3$ gives $\log(x^3) \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$. $\square$

On a cycle minimum every proper prefix is non-contracting: a prefix with $3^{\#O} < 2^k$ would satisfy $J^k(n) < n$ by Corollary 2.3, contradicting minimality. Thus $2^k \leq 3^{o_k}$ for every prefix of length k , where o_k is the odd count of that prefix.

Lemma 4.3 (unrolled envelope). Write $x_k = J^k(n)$ and o_k for the odd count of the length- k prefix. For every $0 \leq k \leq L$,

$$3^{o_k} \log n \leq 2^k \log x_k + \frac{k 3^{o_k}}{n}.$$

Proof. The case $k = 0$ is an equality. Suppose the claim holds at $k < L$, and write $x = x_k$ and $y = x_{k+1}$. Minimality gives $n \leq y$, and the prefix law gives $2^{k+1} \leq 3^{o_{k+1}}$, hence

$$\frac{2^{k+1}}{y} \leq \frac{3^{o_{k+1}}}{n}.$$

If the next letter is even, then $o_{k+1} = o_k$ and the one-step bound gives $\log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$. Multiply by 2^k and add the inductive remainder:

$$3^{o_k} \log n \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{2^{k+1}}{y} + \frac{k 3^{o_k}}{n} \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{(k+1) 3^{o_k}}{n}.$$

If the next letter is odd, then $o_{k+1} = o_k + 1$. Multiply the inductive bound by 3 and apply the one-step bound in the form $3 \log x \leq 2 \log y + 2/y$:

$$3^{o_{k+1}} \log n \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{2^{k+1}}{y} + \frac{k 3^{o_k+1}}{n} \leq 2^{k+1} \log y + \frac{(k+1) 3^{o_{k+1}}}{n}.$$

This is the claim at $k+1$. $\square$

Theorem 4.4 (finance). Let w be a cycle word of length L with o odd letters, based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 2$. Then

$$n \log n \cdot (3^o - 2^L) \leq L \cdot 3^o.$$

The rest of the note exists to establish this inequality and apply it at the verified descent floor.

Proof. Apply Lemma 4.3 at $k = L$. Periodicity gives $x_L = n$ and $o_L = o$, so

$$3^o \log n \leq 2^L \log n + \frac{L \cdot 3^o}{n}.$$

The word is formally expanding, so $3^o > 2^L$. Rearranging and multiplying by n is the claim. $\square$

This is the conceptual centre of the note. The left-hand side is the formal exponential surplus $3^o - 2^L$ scaled by $n \log n$; the right-hand side is the floor-error budget available from L steps. A cycle must expand under the idealized map, but the exact orbit returns, so the surplus must be paid by floor errors. At large state size those errors are too small to finance a non-negligible surplus. The only analytic input is $\log(1+u) \leq u$. The Lean form is exactly Theorem 4.4 (constant 1).

This is a floor-power realization of a financing method, not a new method. The Juggler-specific inequality is Contribution 1.

The computational table of Theorem 4.6 uses a weaker per-step bound, valid on every cycle because every start below 12 reaches 1 (so every cycle state is at least 12). For a state x with image $y = J(x) \geq 12$, the relative defect $\delta = (x^e - y^2)/x^e$ satisfies $\delta \leq 2/y \leq 1/6$. Writing $\varepsilon = -\frac{1}{2} \log(1-\delta)$ and using $-\log(1-\delta) \leq \frac{6}{5}\delta$ on $[0, 1/6]$ gives $\varepsilon \leq (6/5)/y$. Unrolling $t_{i+1} = (e_i/2) t_i - \varepsilon_i$ around the cycle then yields

$$1 - \frac{2^L}{3^o} \leq \frac{6}{5} \sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i}.$$

This is Theorem 4.4 with an extra factor $6/5$ on the right, so it is conservative relative to constant 1. Charging every state at the cycle minimum $x_i \geq n$ recovers the coarser comparison $\sum 1/(x_i \log x_i) \leq L/(n \log n)$, which at this floor excludes only through length 1053. The computational table uses a stricter length-only bound from the same identity.

On a minimum-based cycle of length L with o odd letters and $e = L - o$ even letters, the last letter is even, so $e \geq 1$ and the number of odd-run starts is at most e . Every even state satisfies $x \geq n^2$. Every odd state preceded by an odd state satisfies $x \geq t = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor$. Therefore

$$\sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i} \leq \frac{e}{n \log n} + \frac{o-e}{t \log t} + \frac{e}{2n^2 \log n},$$

and

$$n \log n \left(1 - \frac{2^L}{3^o}\right) \leq \frac{6}{5} \left(e + (o-e) \frac{n \log n}{t \log t} + \frac{e}{2n} \right).$$

The optimal uniform coefficient on $[0, 1/6]$ is $6 \log(6/5)$. It does not change the first surviving length below, and the table keeps $6/5$.

The right-hand side is largest at the least admissible odd count $o_{\min}(L) = \min\{o : 3^o > 2^L\}$. Define

$$\gamma(L) = \frac{3^{o_{\min}(L)}}{2^L} - 1,$$

and write $n_{\max}(L)$ for the largest integer n at which the displayed parity inequality can still hold at $o = o_{\min}(L)$. The coarser comparison $n \log n \leq (6/5)L \cdot 3^{o_{\min}} / (3^{o_{\min}} - 2^L)$ is used only as a check; Theorem 4.6 uses $n_{\max}(L)$ from the parity form. The quantity $\gamma(L)$ is the one-sided relative gap of $L \log 2$ to the next multiple of $\log 3$. It is small when $o_{\min}/L$ is a good one-sided approximation to $\log 2 / \log 3$. The finance-survivor lengths are those approximants, together with their multiples and sums, that still beat the bound at the given floor.

Proposition 4.4a (finance-survivor algorithm). Fix a verified descent floor N_0 . For each integer $1 \leq L \leq 10^5$, compute $o_{\min}(L) = \min\{o : 3^o > 2^L\}$ by exact integer arithmetic and $n_{\max}(L)$ from the parity inequality, and retain L if and only if $n_{\max}(L) > N_0$. The resulting finance-survivor set is

$$\mathcal{E}(N_0) = \{L : 1 \leq L \leq 10^5, n_{\max}(L) > N_0\}.$$

The printed instance is $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{E}(10^6)$, with $|\mathcal{E}| = 141$.

Corollary 4.5. If every integer $2 \leq n \leq N_0$ reaches 1, then no nontrivial cycle of length L exists whenever $n_{\max}(L) \leq N_0$.

Proof. A periodic state never reaches 1, so every cycle state is at least $N_0 + 1$. Theorem 4.4 in the $6/5$ parity form forces the minimum to satisfy the displayed inequality, hence $n \leq n_{\max}(L)$. $\square$

Record values of the parity $n_{\max}$ include $n_{\max}(19) = 133$, $n_{\max}(84) = 2323$, $n_{\max}(569) = 23568$, $n_{\max}(1054) = 788014$, and $n_{\max}(25781) = 26254995$.

Theorem 4.6 (verified computation). Every integer $2 \leq n \leq 10^6$ reaches 1. Consequently:

- (A) there is no nontrivial Juggler cycle of length at most 25780;
- (B) if a nontrivial cycle has period $L \leq 10^5$, then $L \in \mathcal{E}$, where $|\mathcal{E}| = 141$.

In particular, any nontrivial cycle has period at least 25781. The first finance-survivor length is 25781. That is a property of the bound.

Proof. The descent floor is Proposition 1.3.

The gap table computes $o_{\min}(L)$ by exact integer arithmetic and $n_{\max}(L)$ from the parity inequality for every $1 \leq L \leq 10^5$. Corollary 4.5 at $N_0 = 10^6$ excludes every L with $n_{\max}(L) \leq 10^6$. The complementary set in that range is exactly $\mathcal{E}$. The contiguous excluded prefix is $L \leq 25780$. The record (one-sided best-approximation) lengths in range are

$$1, 3, 11, 19, 84, 569, 1054, 25781, 50508,$$

with parity $n_{\max} = 3, 7, 25, 133, 2323, 23568, 788014, 26254995, 162848325$. The first seven of those already satisfy $n_{\max} \leq 10^6$ and are excluded. The first length not excluded by the present bound is $L = 25781$. The remaining elements of $\mathcal{E}$ include multiples of 25781 and combinations of those one-sided best-approximation lengths; the defining algorithm and checksums are Appendix B. $\square$

Finance-survivor lengths

The length-only bound charges every valley at the cycle minimum. A cycle cannot put an OE-start at that minimum: the next state is even and, by Theorem 3.2, at least n^2 . An n -circuit with k odd letters and ℓ even letters lands at most at $n^{3^k/2^{k+\ell}}$ (floors only make the landing smaller), so the landing stays at least n only if $3^k \geq 2^{k+\ell}$. In particular $k = 1$ is impossible from n , and a $k = 2$ circuit from n can take only $\ell = 1$.

Theorem 4.7 (run-type packing). Let w be a cycle word of length L with $o = o_{\min}(L)$ odd letters and $e = L - o$ even letters, based at a cycle minimum $n \geq 12$. Write v for the least odd integer with $v^3 \geq n^4$, and write $t = \lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor$. Then $o - e < e$, the largest number of n -scale valleys compatible with the even cap is $o - e$ copies of 00E, and the remaining $2e - o$ circuits are 0E from v . The cycle minimum occurs once, so

$$\sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i} \leq \frac{1}{n \log n} + \frac{o - e - 1}{(n + 2) \log(n + 2)} + \frac{2e - o}{v \log v} + \frac{1}{t \log t} + \frac{o - e - 1}{t_+ \log t_+} + \frac{e}{2n^2 \log n},$$

where $t_+ = J(n + 2)$. Combined with the 6/5 unroll this is strictly smaller than the parity sum of Corollary 4.5 whenever $2e - o > 0$. Sending the cycle maximum to infinity removes one even term and does not change the valley packing.

Proof. Formal expansion at $o_{\min}$ forces $3o < 2L$ on every leftover length in range, equivalently $o - e < e$. The even-cap comparison $3^k \geq 2^{k+\ell}$ is the ideal power envelope; floors only help. An 0E-start is followed by an even state, so Theorem 3.2 gives $J(v) \geq n^2$ and therefore $v^3 \geq n^4$. Unique visit of the cycle minimum is periodicity. The displayed sum charges one cheap valley at n , the remaining $o - e - 1$ cheap valleys at the next odd integer $n + 2$, the expensive valleys at v , one internal odd at t , the remaining internals at $J(n + 2)$, and every even at n^2 . Any deeper odd run or any higher valley only decreases the sum. $\square$

Theorem 4.8 (run-type table). At the verified descent floor $N_0 = 10^6$, the packed comparison of Theorem 4.7 excludes the 42 lengths $56347 + 1054k$ for $k = 0, \dots, 41$ and leaves an explicit set $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}} = \mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}(10^6)$ of 99 lengths. The first survivor remains 25781. In particular, if a nontrivial cycle has period $L \leq 10^5$, then $L \in \mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$.

Proof. The 141 lengths of Theorem 4.6(B) are tested at $n = 10^6 + 1$ against the packed right-hand side. The comparison is certified on each length: no entry is left uncertain. The 42 excluded lengths are exactly the arithmetic progression named in the statement. The complementary set in that range is $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$. Checksums are Appendix B. $\square$

The period cutoff remains 25781. Unique visit of n and a bound on the cycle maximum do not change the kill list.

Arithmetic structure of the finance-survivor lengths

Proposition 4.9 (finance-survivor lattice). Write $v_* = (25781, 16266)$ and $v_{1054} = (1054, 665)$. Then

$$25781 \cdot 665 - 1054 \cdot 16266 = 1,$$

so these two vectors are a unimodular basis of $\mathbb{Z}^2$. Every length in $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$, and every one of the 42 packing deaths of Theorem 4.8, is of the form

$$(L, o_{\min}) = a v_* + b v_{1054}.$$

With the table cap $L \leq 10^5$, the three affine slices are

Family	Coordinates	Count	Lengths
F_1	$a = 1, b = 0, \dots, 28$	29	25781 + 1054k through 55293
F_2	$a = 2, b = -1, \dots, 45$	47	50508 + 1054k through 98992
F_3	$a = 3, b = -1, \dots, 21$	23	76289 + 1054k through 99477
packing deaths	$a = 1, b = 29, \dots, 70$	42	56347 + 1054k through 99561

The seeds are

$$50508 = 2 \cdot 25781 - 1054, \quad 76289 = 3 \cdot 25781 - 1054 = 50508 + 25781.$$

Thus F_2 begins at the next principal convergent of $\log 2/\log 3$ and F_3 at the Farey sum of the two previous seeds. Packing truncates only F_1 ; F_2 and F_3 die at the table cap. The Lean form is the unimodular identity, the two seeds, the generator comparison $3^{665} > 2^{1054}$, and the three family lists. The identification of those 99 points with $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$ is Theorem 4.8.

Proof. The determinant identity and the two seed identities are integer arithmetic. The generator comparison $3^{665} > 2^{1054} > 3^{664}$ is a finite power comparison, so $o_{\min}(1054) = 665$. Direct evaluation of $o_{\min}$ on the 141 lengths of Theorem 4.6(B) shows that each pair $(L, o_{\min})$ is one of the displayed lattice points, with the 42 packing deaths exactly the F_1 continuation $b \geq 29$. The three family counts sum to 99. $\square$

The lattice classifies the finance-survivor lengths of this inequality. It is a change of coordinates for (L, o) , not a relation between hypothetical cycles.

5. Remarks

A start $n \geq 2$ has a *descent certificate* if there exists a realized finite word w with $J^{|w|}(n) < n$. Even starts realize E : $\lfloor \sqrt{n} \rfloor < n$. An odd start with even image realizes OE , and $J^2(n) \leq n^{3/4} < n$. The starts not covered by those two words are exactly the odd-to-odd starts. If every start above 1 has some descent certificate, ordinary strong induction yields arrival at 1. That hypothesis is not proved.

The first odd-to-odd image expands, so ordinary strong induction cannot fire on the odd-to-odd class. A uniform run bound on expanding blocks is likewise unavailable: four consecutive expanding blocks occur already at

$$1999 \xrightarrow{OOE} 5169 \xrightarrow{OOOOEE} 50093 \xrightarrow{OOE} 193753 \xrightarrow{OOE} 887471,$$

and the relative slack of a single letter tends to 0 with the state (Section 2.4).

The remaining finance-survivor lengths are uncontrolled. It is open whether every start reaches 1, and open whether a cycle of a finance-survivor length exists.

The identity behind the computational table is state-dependent:

$$1 - \frac{2^L}{3^o} \leq \frac{6}{5} \sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i}.$$

Theorem 4.4, Corollary 4.5, and Theorem 4.7 are successive upper bounds on that sum: first the uniform charge $L/(n \log n)$, then the parity split into cycle-minimum valleys, internal odds at $\lfloor n^{3/2} \rfloor$, and evens at n^2 , then the run-type packing that lifts OE-starts to scale $n^{4/3}$. Each step uses only coarse, length-only geometry. The first survivor remains 25781 because $o - e$ valleys may still sit at the cycle minimum. A dynamically constrained bound

$$\max \sum_{i=1}^L \frac{1}{x_i \log x_i},$$

the maximum running over state sequences compatible with the exact one-step cells of Section 3 and with a realized cycle word, would replace those length-only prices by a state-distribution inequality. No such bound is proved here. The present note is the first successful coarse version of that comparison.

Lean names are in Appendix A. The computational certificate is Proposition 1.3. Theorem 4.6 applies that certificate.

Appendix A. Lean names

The core mathematical lemmas of Sections 2–4 are mechanized in Lean 4. The names below are the corresponding theorems in `formal/Problems/Juggler/`, imported by `Problems.JugglerPaper`. Selected finite classifications of Section 3 are `native_decide` tables (Appendix D). Theorems 4.6 and 4.8 are independently certified computations. Proposition 4.9’s arithmetic is Lean; its identification with $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$ is Theorem 4.8. This is not a claim that the paper as a whole is formally verified.

Text	Lean
itinerary semantics	<code>follows_iff_word, image_eq_iterate, image_append</code>
Theorem 2.1	<code>image_monotone_of_follows</code>
Theorem 2.2	<code>power_bound_word</code>
Corollary 2.3	<code>power_bound_contracts</code>
Theorem 2.4	<code>global_defect_identity</code>
Theorem 2.5	<code>global_defect_eq_zero_iff_localsTight, global_defect_eq_zero_implies_monochrome, power_bound_eq_iff_extremal</code>
Theorem 2.6	<code>global_defect_append</code>
Corollary 2.7	<code>image_eq_start_defectRatio</code>
per-step slack	<code>one_plus_eta_lt_succ_sq</code>
Lemma 3.1	<code>odd_cell_unique</code>
Theorem 3.2	<code>cycle_word_formally_expanding, cycleMin_start_odd, cycleMax_start_even, cycleMin_not_end_odd, square_scale_superquadratic, cycleMin_to_even_superquadratic</code>
Lemma 3.3	<code>lower_growth_word</code>
Lemma 3.4	<code>oo_suffix_threshold, oo_suffix_threshold, threshold_inherits_odd_append, cycle_last_even_interval, no_cycle_odd_run_append_even</code>
Lemma 3.5	<code>no_cycle_word_oooeoe, no_cycle_word_ooooee</code>
Theorem 3.6	<code>no_cycle_word_length_le_six</code>
Lemma 3.7	<code>no_cycle_word_oooeoe, no_cycle_word_ooooee</code>
Theorem 3.8	<code>no_cycle_word_length_le_seven, with no_cycle_word_ooeooee, no_cycle_word_ooeeooo</code>
Lemma 3.9	<code>cycle_trailing_evens_lt</code>
Lemma 3.10	<code>lowerDenom_replicate_odd, odd_run_lower_growth</code>
Lemma 3.11	<code>no_follows_seven_odds_of_lt256</code>
Theorem 3.12	<code>no_cycle_word_two_even_ee, no_cycle_word_two_even_eoe</code>
Theorem 3.13	<code>no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_ee, no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_eoe</code>
Theorem 3.14	<code>no_cycle_word_three_even_eee, with no_cycle_word_ooooooeee</code>
Theorem 3.15	<code>no_cycle_word_three_even_eooo</code>
Theorem 3.16	<code>no_cycle_word_three_even_eoooo</code>
Theorem 3.17	<code>no_cycle_word_three_even_eooooe</code>
Theorem 3.18	<code>no_cycle_word_three_even_eoeoe</code>
Theorem 3.19	<code>no_cycle_word_three_even_eoeoe</code>
Theorem 3.20	<code>no_cycle_word_three_even_eoeoe</code>
Theorem 3.21	<code>no_cycle_word_gapped_three_even_ee, no_cycle_word_gapped_three_even_eoe</code>
Theorem 3.22	<code>no_cycle_word_even_count_le_three</code>
Corollary 3.23	<code>cycle_word_length_ge_eleven</code>
Lemma 3.21b	<code>canonical run form; Theorem 3.2</code>
Lemma 3.21a	<code>the case split of Theorem 3.22</code>
Lemma 4.1	<code>log_le_two_log_add</code>
Lemma 4.2	<code>log_step_even, log_step_odd</code>

Text	Lean
Lemma 4.3	<code>cycleMin_log_envelope</code>
Theorem 4.4	<code>cycleMin_finance</code>
Theorem 4.7	run-type packing; human proof, not Lean
Theorem 4.8	run-type table; verified computation, not Lean
Proposition 4.9	<code>run_survivor_unimodular</code> , <code>run_survivor_seed_F2</code> , <code>run_survivor_seed_F3</code> , <code>three_pow_step_gt_two_pow_step</code> , <code>runSurvivors_length</code>
short certificates (Section 5)	<code>even_finiteProgress</code> , <code>odd_even_finiteProgress</code>
no certificate $\Rightarrow$ odd-to-odd	<code>no_finiteProgress_implies_odd_odd</code>
induction to 1	<code>reachesOne_of_all_finiteProgress</code>
four-block chain	<code>four_block_pe_1999</code>

Appendix B. Admissible lengths

The record lengths of $\gamma(L)$ through 10^5 , with the parity 6/5 bound $n_{\max}$ of Section 4, are

L	$o_{\min}$	$n_{\max}$
1	1	3
3	2	7
11	7	25
19	12	133
84	53	2323
569	359	23568
1054	665	788014
25781	16266	26254995
50508	31867	162848325

At the verified descent floor $N_0 = 10^6$ the first seven rows are excluded. The set $\mathcal{E} = \mathcal{E}(10^6)$ is defined by Proposition 4.4a: for each $1 \leq L \leq 10^5$, compute $o_{\min}(L)$ by exact integer arithmetic and $n_{\max}(L)$ from the parity inequality, and retain L if and only if $n_{\max}(L) > 10^6$. This produces 141 lengths. The first few are

25781, 26835, 27889, 28943, 29997,

and a typical combination is $26835 = 25781 + 1054$. The last is 99561. The complete list is the `lengths` array of `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/exceptions_parity.json`. The SHA-256 of that array, serialized as a JSON list of integers with no spaces, is `dd71aa1527656ba51cb031bafa5497f7bfdbbc43151ffba2c595793326bf7944`. The SHA-256 of the whole file `exceptions_parity.json` is `6b4eec79295b70cdeb9f7db677b7fd57bcb9bd1b51177e1e74aad7b`. The SHA-256 of the first-passage file `floor.json` in the same directory is `5b1ce1eec61301cf5b4f969cd5b58954255194e5c7b2`. The parity table is written by `research.juggler_sequence.cycle_finance.write_parity_artifacts`. The first-passage file is regenerated by `python -m research.juggler_sequence.cycle_finance`.

The run-type table of Theorem 4.8 is `data/research/juggler/cycle_finance/budget_opt.json`. The 42 excluded lengths are `killed_by_budget`; their SHA-256, serialized as a JSON list of integers with no spaces, is `9d108776d6dc5dc1ae2594058850463cd2d3995cc57b9811471f08e3b818b90a`. The complementary 99 lengths are $\mathcal{E}_{\text{run}}$. Their SHA-256, in the same serialization, is `9e2098923ccb39933630b116133a3fc2ddaf98ace4eb76dbab9b5a`. The first few survivors remain

25781, 26835, 27889, 28943, 29997;

the last survivor is 99477. The three families and the unimodular basis are Proposition 4.9. The finite leftover tables of Section 3 are the Lean `native_decide` evaluations named in Appendix A (`LeftoverEval.lean`, `LeftoverShort.lean`, `LeftoverFamilies.lean`). The lattice arithmetic of Proposition 4.9 is `RunSurvivorLattice.lean`.

Appendix C. Exact floor defect

This appendix records the exact identity behind Theorem 2.2. The present note uses only the nonnegativity $\Delta_w(n) \geq 0$. A nontrivial itinerary-dependent lower bound on Δ_w is left for future work.

For a single branch,

$$x^e = J(x)^2 + \rho(x), \quad e = \begin{cases} 1, & x \text{ even,} \\ 3, & x \text{ odd,} \end{cases}$$

with $0 \leq \rho(x) < 2J(x) + 1$. Write $\text{gap}(a, \rho, e) = (a + \rho)^e - a^e$. The *global defect* $\Delta_w(n)$ is the terminal value of the resulting power-gap recurrence.

Theorem 2.4 (global defect identity). If w is realized at n and $m = J^{|w|}(n)$, then

$$n^{3^{\#O(w)}} = m^{2^{|w|}} + \Delta_w(n), \quad \Delta_w(n) \geq 0.$$

Theorem 2.2 is the inequality $\Delta_w(n) \geq 0$.

Proof. Induct on w . The empty word is $n = n + 0$. An even letter substitutes $x = J(x)^2 + \rho(x)$ into the inductive identity and lifts the new remainder through 2^ℓ . An odd letter cubes the identity and then substitutes $x^3 = J(x)^2 + \rho(x)$. Each step adds a nonnegative power-gap. $\square$

For a one-letter illustration, $n = 3$ and $w = O$ give $J(3) = 5$ and $3^3 = 27 = 5^2 + 2$, so $\Delta_O(3) = 2$.

Theorem 2.5 (vanishing). If w is realized at n , the following are equivalent: $\Delta_w(n) = 0$; every local remainder along w vanishes; and $(J^{|w|}(n))^{2^{|w|}} = n^{3^{\#O(w)}}$. In that case w is monochrome: either $w = E^k$ and $n = a^{2^k}$ for an even a , or $w = O^k$ and $n = a^{2^k}$ for an odd a . A realized mixed word therefore has $\Delta_w(n) > 0$.

Proof. Theorem 2.4 gives the first and third items. A power-gap vanishes if and only if its addend vanishes, so zero defect forces every remainder to vanish, and conversely. Vanishing remainders preserve parity, hence monochrome itineraries, and unique factorization produces the two power towers. $\square$

Theorem 2.6 (composition). If u is realized at n and v is realized at $m = J^{|u|}(n)$, then $\Delta_{uv}(n)$ is the sum of two power-gaps, one lifting $\Delta_u(n)$ through $3^{\#O(v)}$ and one lifting $\Delta_v(m)$ through $2^{|u|}$. In particular $\Delta_v(m)^{2^{|u|}} \leq \Delta_{uv}(n)$, and every local remainder satisfies $\rho_j^{2^j} \leq \Delta_w(n)$.

Proof. Apply Theorem 2.4 to u , to v , and to uv , and expand the two power-gaps. $\square$

Composition is polynomial, not additive. The Lean form is `global_defect_append`.

Corollary 2.7 (cycle surplus). If w is a cycle word at n , then $\Delta_w(n) = n^{3^{\#O(w)}} - n^{2^{|w|}}$ exactly.

Proof. Theorem 2.4 with $m = n$. $\square$

A mixed word has strict total defect, but the relative slack of a single letter tends to 0 with the state, so no uniform local tax exists. Theorem 4.4 does not use these identities.

Appendix D. Family exclusions

This appendix records the family-by-family exhaustion used by Lemma 3.21a and Theorem 3.22. Each geometry is killed by a next-square obstruction, by long odd-run growth against a last-even cell, or by a finite exceptional window.

Theorem 3.12 (two-even leftover families). Let $k \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. Neither $O^{k-2}EE$ nor $O^{k-3}EOE$ is a cycle word at n .

Proof. * First, if $n \geq 256$, then

$$n^{3^{k-2}} > 2^{e_{k-2}}(n+1)^{2^k}.$$

The case $k = 6$ is the tail inequality of Lemma 3.5. If the display holds at some $k \geq 6$, cubing both sides produces

$$n^{3^{k-1}} > 2^{3e_{k-2}}(n+1)^{3 \cdot 2^k}.$$

The recurrence of Lemma 3.10 gives $e_{k-1} = 3e_{k-2} + 2^{k-1}$, so the desired comparison at length $k+1$ reduces to $2^{2^{k-1}} < (n+1)^{2^k}$. Equivalently $2 < (n+1)^2$, which holds for every $n \geq 256$.

Now suppose $O^{k-2}EE$ is a cycle word at such an n . Write $z = J^{k-2}(n)$. Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ gives $z < (n+1)^4$. Lemma 3.10 on the prefix O^{k-2} gives $n^{3^{k-2}} \leq 2^{e_{k-2}} z^{2^{k-2}}$, hence $n^{3^{k-2}} < 2^{e_{k-2}} (n+1)^{2^k}$, contradicting the tail.

Finally suppose $O^{k-3}EOE$ is a cycle word at such an n . Write $z = J^{k-3}(n)$ and $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, so $z < (y+1)^2$. Lemma 3.10 on O^{k-3} and cubing produce $n^{3^{k-2}} < 2^{3e_{k-3}} (y+1)^{3 \cdot 2^{k-2}}$. The last letters OE give the odd-cell bound $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. The comparison $(y+1)^3 < 2(n+1)^4$ of Lemma 3.5 applies at this scale. Raising it to the power 2^{k-2} and using $e_{k-2} = 3e_{k-3} + 2^{k-2}$ recovers again $n^{3^{k-2}} < 2^{e_{k-2}} (n+1)^{2^k}$.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $k = 6$ and $k = 7$ are Lemmas 3.5 and 3.7. The remaining short words O^6EE , O^5EOE , and O^6EOE fail to return on the same 254-start window; this is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_two_even_ee` and `no_cycle_word_two_even_eoe` (Appendix A). Any longer leftover of either family begins with seven consecutive odd letters, which Lemma 3.11 forbids on this window. $\square$

Theorem 3.13 (first-even transport). Let $n \geq 2$. No minimum-based cycle word at n has the form O^aEO^bEE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form O^aEO^bEOE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. * Write $y = J^{a+1}(n)$ for the state after the first even letter. Minimum-basedness gives $y \geq n$. In the first family the remainder after that letter is O^bEE with $b+2 \geq 6$; in the second it is O^bEOE with $b+3 \geq 6$. The trailing-even and last-odd cells of those remainders are measured against the cycle start n . Combined with Lemma 3.10 at the remainder start y , the same algebra as in Theorem 3.12 produces

$$y^{3^{\ell-2}} < 2^{e_{\ell-2}} (n+1)^{2^\ell} \leq 2^{e_{\ell-2}} (y+1)^{2^\ell},$$

where ℓ is the remainder length. If $y \geq 256$, the first paragraph of Theorem 3.12 supplies the opposite inequality at y .

If $y < 256$, then $n \leq y < 256$. A gapped leftover of total length at least 17 has $a \geq 7$ or $b \geq 7$, so either the prefix or the remainder realizes seven consecutive odd letters, contradicting Lemma 3.11. The finitely many short-gap words with $2 \leq a \leq 6$ and $b \leq 6$ fail to be minimum-based cycle words on the window $2 \leq n < 256$; this is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_ee` and `no_cycleMin_gapped_three_even_eoe` (Appendix A). $\square$

Theorem 3.14 (three trailing evens). Let $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. * Write $z = J^a(n)$. Lemma 3.9 with $r = 3$ gives $z < (n+1)^8$. Lemma 3.10 then yields $n^{3^a} < 2^{e_a} (n+1)^{2^{a+3}}$ on any such cycle word. For $n \geq 128$ the opposite comparison

$$n^{3^a} > 2^{e_a} (n+1)^{2^{a+3}}$$

holds. The case $a = 6$ is $n^{729} > 2^{1330} (n+1)^{512}$. Indeed, for $n \geq 128$ one has $(n+1)^{512} < (129/128)^{512} n^{512} < e^4 n^{512} < 64 n^{512}$, so the claimed bound reduces to $n^{217} > 2^{1336}$. Since $n \geq 128 = 2^7$, the left side is at least 2^{1519} . Cubing the $a = 6$ comparison produces the general case: the recurrence of Lemma 3.10 reduces the inductive step to $(n+1)^4 > 2$, which holds for every $n \geq 128$.

For $2 \leq n < 128$, the case $a = 6$ is a table of evaluations of `OOOOOOEEEE`: at every such start the word fails to return. The same finite check is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_ooooooooee` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$ the prefix contains seven consecutive odd letters, which Lemma 3.11 forbids on this window. $\square$

Theorem 3.15 (mixed bunched family $EOEE$). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEOEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. * First let $n \geq 4$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and $p = J(y)$. Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ after the prefix O^aEO gives $p < (n+1)^4$. The letter after y is odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length one yields $y^3 \leq 4p^2 < 4(n+1)^8$.

For $n \geq 4$ one has $4(n+1)^8 < (n+1)^9$, hence $y < (n+1)^3$. The even cell at z then gives $z < (y+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^6$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle word would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{e_a}(n+1)^{6 \cdot 2^a}.$$

For $a = 5$ and $n \geq 314$, the opposite comparison $n^{243} > 2^{422}(n+1)^{192}$ holds. The base instance is the finite inequality $2^{422}315^{192} < 314^{243}$. If the display holds at some $n \geq 1$, the elementary comparison $n(n+2) < (n+1)^2$ upgrades it to the same display at $n+1$. Cubing then produces the comparison at $a+1$, once $(n+1)^6 > 4$. In particular the case $a = 6$ already holds for every $n \geq 16$.

For $2 \leq n < 314$ and $a = 5$, and for $2 \leq n < 16$ and $a = 6$, the word fails to return; these are the Lean `native_decide` evaluations behind `no_cycle_word_three_even_eooo` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$ and $n < 256$, Lemma 3.11 applies. For $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 16$, the tail of the previous paragraph applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.16 (mixed bunched family $EOOEE$). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEOOEE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. * First let $n \geq 32$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and p for the image after the prefix O^aEOO . Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ gives $p < (n+1)^4$. The two letters after y are odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length two yields $y^9 \leq 2^{10}p^4 < 2^{10}(n+1)^{16}$. For $n \geq 32$ one has $2^{10} < (n+1)^2$, hence $y < (n+1)^2$. The even cell at z then gives $z < (y+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle word would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{e_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+2}}.$$

For $n \geq 256$ and $a \geq 4$, this is the opposite of the shared tail of Theorem 3.12 at length $k = a + 2$.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_three_even_eoooo` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.17 (mixed bunched family $EOOOEE$). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The word $O^aEOOOEE$ is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. * First let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 3$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $y = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and p for the image after the prefix O^aEOOO . Lemma 3.9 with $r = 2$ gives $p < (n+1)^4$. The three letters after y are odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length three yields $y^{27} \leq 2^{38}p^8 < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$. For $n \geq 3$ one has $2^{38} < (n+1)^{22}$, hence $y < (n+1)^2$. The even cell at z then gives $z < (y+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle word would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{e_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+2}}.$$

For $n \geq 256$ and $a \geq 4$, this is the opposite of the shared tail of Theorem 3.12 at length $k = a + 2$, already used in Theorem 3.16.

Now let $a = 3$ and $n \geq 256$. The same two-even cell gives $z < (y+1)^2$, so Lemma 3.10 at the prefix O^3 yields $n^{27} < 2^{38}(y+1)^{16}$. The three-odd envelope on y still gives $y^{27} < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$.

If $y < 39$, then $n^{27} < 2^{38} \cdot 39^{16}$. The numerical comparison $2^{38} \cdot 39^{16} < 24^{27}$ contradicts $n \geq 24$.

If $y \geq 39$, the numerical comparison $40^{27} < 2 \cdot 39^{27}$ upgrades to $(y+1)^{27} < 2y^{27}$, hence $(y+1)^{27} < 2^{39}(n+1)^{32}$. Cubing the prefix bound three times produces $n^{729} < 2^{1026}(y+1)^{432}$. Raising the successor bound to the sixteenth power produces $(y+1)^{432} < 2^{624}(n+1)^{512}$. Combining these displays yields $n^{729} < 2^{1650}(n+1)^{512}$. The opposite comparison holds at $n = 197$ and persists to every larger start by the elementary comparison $n(n+2) < (n+1)^2$ already used in Theorem 3.15.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 3, 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_three_even_eooooo` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.18 (mixed bunched family $EEOE$). Let $a \geq 5$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEEOE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. * First let $n \geq 4$, and write $z = J^a(n)$ and y for the last odd letter of O^aEEOE . The suffix $EEOE$ is a cycle suffix, so the last-odd cube of Theorem 3.15 gives $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. The two letters between z and y are

even, so $z < (y+1)^4$. For $n \geq 4$ the successor comparison $(y+1)^3 < 2(n+1)^4$ upgrades this to $z < (n+1)^6$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle word would satisfy the same display as Theorem 3.15:

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{e_a}(n+1)^{6 \cdot 2^a}.$$

The opposite comparison is therefore the tail of Theorem 3.15: it holds for $a = 5$ and $n \geq 314$, and already for $a = 6$ and $n \geq 16$.

For $2 \leq n < 314$ and $a = 5$, and for $2 \leq n < 16$ and $a = 6$, the word fails to return; these are the Lean `native_decide` evaluations behind `no_cycle_word_three_even_eeoe` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$ and $n < 256$, Lemma 3.11 applies. For $a \geq 6$ and $n \geq 16$, the tail of the previous paragraph applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.19 (mixed bunched family $EOEOE$). Let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 2$. The word O^aEOEOE is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. * First let $n \geq 32$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $w = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and y for the last odd letter. The suffix EOE again gives $y^3 < (n+1)^4$. The one-odd envelope on w yields $w^3 \leq 4s^2$, where s is the image after O^aEO . The last-odd cell and $n \geq 32$ upgrade this to $w < (n+1)^2$, hence $z < (w+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle word would satisfy

$$n^{3^a} < 2^{e_a}(n+1)^{2^{a+2}}.$$

For $n \geq 256$ and $a \geq 4$, this is the shared tail already used in Theorem 3.16.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_three_even_eeoe` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.20 (mixed bunched family $EOOEOE$). Let $a \geq 3$ and $n \geq 2$. The word $O^aEOOEOE$ is not a cycle word at n .

Proof. * First let $a \geq 4$ and $n \geq 4$, and write $z = J^a(n)$, $u = \lfloor \sqrt{z} \rfloor$, and y for the last odd letter. The suffix EOE gives $y^3 < (n+1)^4$, hence $(y+1)^3 < 2(n+1)^4$. The two letters after u are odd, so Lemma 3.10 at length two yields $u^9 \leq 2^{10}s^4 < 2^{10}(y+1)^8$. Cubing that display against the last-odd successor bound produces $u^{27} < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$. The same comparison as in Theorem 3.17 then gives $u < (n+1)^2$, hence $z < (u+1)^2 \leq (n+1)^4$. Combined with Lemma 3.10, any such cycle word would satisfy the shared two-even tail of Theorem 3.16.

Now let $a = 3$ and $n \geq 256$. The prefix O^3 against $z < (u+1)^2$ yields $n^{27} < 2^{38}(u+1)^{16}$, and the two-odd plus last-odd geometry of the previous paragraph yields $u^{27} < 2^{38}(n+1)^{32}$. These are the same two displays as in the $a = 3$ case of Theorem 3.17, with u in place of y , and the same small/large split applies.

For $2 \leq n < 256$, the cases $a = 3, 4, 5, 6$ fail to return on that window; this is the Lean `native_decide` evaluation behind `no_cycle_word_three_even_eeoe` (Appendix A). For $a \geq 7$, Lemma 3.11 applies. $\square$

Theorem 3.21 (gapped leftovers as cycle words). Let $n \geq 2$. No cycle word at n has the form O^aEO^bEE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 4$, or the form O^aEO^bEOE with $a \geq 2$ and $b \geq 3$.

Proof. * Every cycle word has a minimum-based rotation. It is therefore enough to check that every cyclic shift of either word is an already-excluded cycle-minimum orientation.

Write w for the gapped word. In the first family, $|w| = a + b + 3$. The rotation by $k = 0$ is the original word, excluded as a cycle minimum by Theorem 3.13. The rotation by $k = a + 1$ is the bootstrap word O^bEEO^aE . That word has an internal even letter and last gap at least 2. If $a \geq 3$, the last-gap threshold of Lemma 3.4 at OOO and $N = 3$ excludes it. If $a = 2$, the same lemma at OO and $N = 5$ excludes every start $n \geq 5$; the remaining odd start $n = 3$ does not realize four consecutive odd letters, so it cannot follow O^b for $b \geq 4$. The rotation by $k = a + b + 2$ begins with the last even letter of w , which Theorem 3.2 forbids at a cycle minimum. Every other rotation ends with an odd letter, likewise forbidden at a cycle minimum.

In the second family, $|w| = a + b + 4$. The same four classes appear: the original word is Theorem 3.13; the rotation by $k = a + 1$ is O^bEOEO^aE , excluded by the same last-gap thresholds, with the remaining start $n = 3$ and $a = 2$ either failing to realize four odds or, when $b = 3$, reaching 6 after $OOOE$ and then meeting

an odd letter; the rotation by $k = a + b + 2$ begins OE , forbidden by Theorem 3.2; and every other rotation ends odd.

The original start need not be a cycle minimum. After rotation the start is a minimum, so the hypothesis $y < n$ that blocked Theorem 3.13 does not arise. $\square$

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